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Set up a local Postman MCP server

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The local server is based on STDIO transport and is hosted locally on an environment of your choice. STDIO is a lightweight solution that's ideal for integration with editors and tools like Visual Studio Code. Install an MCP-compatible VS Code extension, such as GitHub Copilot, Claude for VS Code, or other AI assistants that support MCP. The local server only supports API key authentication (with a Postman API key or Bearer token).

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Before you begin

Local servers only support API key authentication, so you'll need to generate a [Postman API key](#). For an overview of the server, remote versus local, and when to use each configuration, see [Use AI agents with the Postman API](#).

Supported configurations

The local server supports the same [tool configurations](#) as the remote server—**Minimal** (default), **Code**, and **Full**—selected with a command-line flag.

Use the `--region` flag to specify the Postman API region (`us` or `eu`), or set the `POSTMAN_API_BASE_URL` environment variable directly. By default, the server uses the `us` option.

To run the server as a Node application, install [Node.js](#) before getting started.

Claude Code

To install the MCP server in Claude Code, run one of the following commands in your terminal:

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```
$ claude mcp add postman --env POSTMAN_API_KEY=<POSTMAN_API_KEY> -- npx @postman/postman-mcp-server@latest
```

Cursor

Click the button to install the local Postman MCP server in Cursor:

[Add to Cursor](#)

Manual installation

To manually integrate your MCP server with Cursor and VS Code, create a `.vscode/mcp.json` file in your project and add one of the following JSON blocks to it. You can optionally include the `--region` flag to specify the Postman API region (`us` or `eu`). Defaults to `us` (in the `args` array, specify it as `"--region"`, `"eu"`).

Minimal Code Full

```
1  {
2    "servers": {
3      "postman-api-mcp": {
4        "type": "stdio",
5        "command": "npx",
6        "args": [
7          "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
8        ],
9        "env": {
10         "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "${input:postman-api-key}"
11       }
12     }
13   },
14   "inputs": [
15     {
16       "id": "postman-api-key",
17       "type": "promptString",
18       "description": "Enter your Postman API key"
19     }
20   ]
21 }
```

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Click the button to install the local Postman MCP server in VS Code:

[VS Code](#) [Install Server](#)

Manual configuration

You can manually integrate your MCP server with VS Code to use it with extensions that support MCP. Add the optional `--region` flag to specify the Postman API region (`us` or `eu`). Defaults to `us` (in the `args` array, specify it as `"--region"`, `"eu"`).

To create a manual configuration, create a `mcp.json` file in your project and add one of the following JSON blocks to it:

[Minimal](#) [Code](#) [Full](#)

```
1  {
2    "servers": {
3      "postman": {
4        "type": "stdio",
5        "command": "npx",
6        "args": [
7          "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
8        ],
9        "env": {
10         "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "${input:postman-api-key}"
11       }
12     }
13   },
14   "inputs": [
15     {
16       "id": "postman-api-key",
17       "type": "promptString",
18       "description": "Enter your Postman API key"
19     }
20   ]
21 }
```

Claude

To integrate the local Postman MCP server with Claude, check the [latest Postman MCP server release](#) and get the `.mcpb` file:

Minimal — `postman-api-mcp-minimal.mcpb`

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For more information, see the [Claude Desktop Extensions](#) documentation.

Codex

To install the local server, use the API key installation method. Set the `POSTMAN_API_KEY` environment variable and invoke the MCP server using `npx`.

Minimal Code Full

```
$ codex mcp add postman --env POSTMAN_API_KEY=<POSTMAN_API_KEY> -- npx @postman/postman-mcp-server
```

Antigravity CLI

To install the MCP server in Antigravity CLI, run the following command:

```
$ agy mcp add postman-mcp "npx @postman/mcp-server --minimal --env POSTMAN_API_KEY=<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
```

GitHub Copilot CLI

Use the Copilot CLI to interactively add the MCP server:

```
$ /mcp add
```

Manual installation

Copy the following JSON config into the `~/.copilot/mcp-config.json` file:

Minimal Code Full

```
1 {
2   "mcpServers": {
3     "postman": {
4       "command": "npx",
5       "args": [
```

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```
8      "env": {
9          "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
10     }
11 }
12 }
13 }
```

Kiro

To install the local Postman MCP Server in Kiro, click the install button for the version that you want to use:

Minimal

Code

Full



Add to Kiro



Add to Kiro



Add to Kiro



To install the Postman MCP server with Kiro powers, go to [Kiro Powers](#) and navigate to **API Testing with Postman** in the **Browse powers** section. Then, click **Add to Kiro**.

Manual installation

To install the Postman MCP Server manually, do the following:

1. Launch Kiro and click the Kiro ghost icon in the left sidebar.
2. Add an MCP Server and select either **User Config** or **Workspace Config** to install the Postman MCP server.
3. Add the following JSON block to the `mcp.json` configuration file:

```
1  {
2      "mcpServers": {
3          "postman": {
4              "command": "npx",
5              "args": [
6                  "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
7              ],
8              "env": {
9                  "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
10             },
11             "disabled": false,
12             "autoApprove": []
```



15 }

Docker

To install the Postman MCP server in Docker, see the [Postman MCP server](#) at Docker MCP Hub. Click + **Add to Docker Desktop** to automatically install it.

To run the Postman MCP server image in Docker, run the following command in your terminal. Docker automatically discovers, downloads, and runs the Postman MCP server image:

```
$ docker run -i -e POSTMAN_API_KEY="<POSTMAN_API_KEY>" mcp/postman
```

Manual installation

To build and run the server in Docker manually, run the `docker build -t postman-api-mcp-stdio .` command. Then, run one of the following commands:

Minimal Full

```
$ docker run -i -e POSTMAN_API_KEY="<POSTMAN_API_KEY>" postman-api-mcp-stdio
```

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No

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